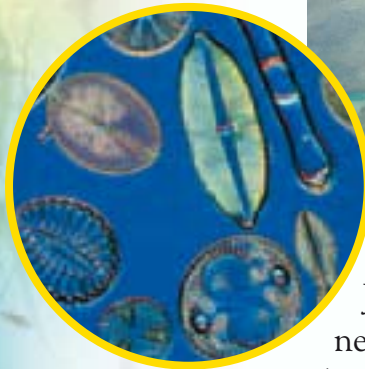


Water worlds

All plant life started in the water with algae, the first plant family. Today, an incredible 85 per cent of plants live in the oceans. They have special features to help them survive in water.

Water of life

Seaweed is a type of algae. It does not have roots, but absorbs water and nutrients through its fronds. It needs to stay covered in water – if it gets washed ashore, it will die.



Some algae are so tiny, 25 million can fit in a teaspoon!



See the light

Just like land plants, algae needs sunlight to make food. Algae can be red, yellow, green, or brown; these colours detect sunlight at different depths in the sea.



Stuck on you

These slimy tubes are holdfasts. They keep a plant rooted in one place. But they are not actually roots because they do not absorb nutrients.